Capecitabine + rectal radiotherapy

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00586 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Tablets, visits and practical planning

A simple guide to what happens before treatment, on treatment days and at home. Your own service confirms appointments and prescriptions.

STEP 1

Treatment phases and appointments

Take capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–5 of each 7-day cycle with radiotherapy, for a maximum of 5–6 cycles. Days 6–7 are not routine tablet days. Follow the team's written instructions if radiotherapy or tablets are interrupted.

STEP 2

Checks after treatment

Keep reviewing bowel, bladder, skin, fatigue and nutrition effects during and after the course. Late effects and surgical assessment follow the radiation/colorectal team plan. Do not automatically extend tablets to make up missed radiation days or continue beyond the planned course.

STEP 3

Access and practical support

No intravenous (IV) port or infusion pump is needed for capecitabine itself; separate treatments may differ. Radiation appointments, tablet supply, meals and transport should be planned together.

Keeping tablets safe

Keep the original labelled packaging away from children. Follow the storage label and pharmacy handling instructions. Do not share tablets or discard them in household waste.

If treatment is interrupted

Tell the team which doses were missed and why. Never extend the course, double a dose or move tablet days yourself. Ask for a revised written plan.

Questions about your appointments

Ask about transport, blood-test location, pharmacy collection and a named contact for appointment changes. Booking arrangements differ between centres.

Radiotherapy planning and recovery

The radiation team plans the field and explains positioning and preparation. Treatment-related bowel, bladder and skin effects can continue after the last session; keep reporting them.

Sources: NCCP 00586 v3 · official regimen · eviQ: taking capecitabine and managing symptoms (NCCP defines the Irish schedule) · NCI: radiation side effects. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.